
Lingua Franca toolchain — authoring and compiling evaluation workloads

LF toolchain and compile pipeline

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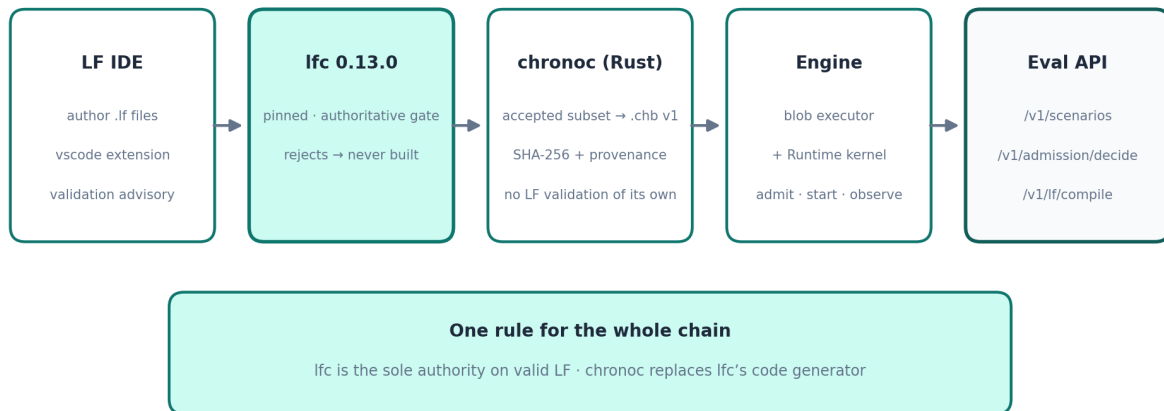
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Workloads evaluated through the API can be authored as Lingua Franca programs and compiled to the binary blob (**.chb**) the ChronoHive engine executes. This is optional: the API and the worked example need nothing beyond a Python 3 interpreter. This doc is for evaluators who want to define their own workloads in LF.

The chain

The toolchain chain — IDE to API



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Rules of the chain:

- 1. Author** in the LF IDE (extension `lf-lang.vscode-lingua-franca`, needs Java 17+ for its language server; `.vscode/` in `lf/` is preconfigured). In-editor validation is advisory.
- 2. Validate** with the pinned real `lfc` v0.13.0 — the sole authority on what is valid LF. Anything `lfc` rejects is never compiled.
- 3. Lower** with `chronoc`: it consumes only `lfc`-accepted sources in the documented subset and emits a versioned `.chb` blob. `chronoc` performs no LF language validation of its own — `lfc` is the frontend, `chronoc` replaces `lfc`'s code generator with blob lowering.
- 4. Execute**: the engine parses/validates the blob and drives admission through the real `Runtime` kernel. No generated LF code runs anywhere in this path; there is no LF runtime in the execution path.

5. Evaluate: the workload shapes (train / checkpoint / prefetch) parameterize API scenarios (`jobs`, `ckpt_gb`, `prefetch_gb`, ...), and a compiled blob is the deployment artifact the engine admits against.

Guided demo

scripts/demo-lf.sh walks the whole chain in one go: it shows the LF source, validates it with the pinned **lfc**, compiles it with **chronoc** to a **.chb** blob, and prints the blob's provenance (hashes, pins, shape). Needs a JVM (Java 17+) and internet on first run (one-time pinned-**lfc** download, SHA-256 verified).

```
scripts/demo-lf.sh
```

Compiling

The canonical path is the compile client, which takes the **complete project** (every **.lf** file as a file map) and supports three modes:

```
# 1. Hosted compile API (needs a TOC-executed key with a compile license):
python3 clients/compile_client.py --api-url https://api.layer1labs.ai \
    --api-key "$CHRONOHIVE_API_KEY" --capacity storage_bw=100 -o /tmp/io.chb

# 2. Local pinned toolchain (lfc + chronoc on PATH, or LFC/CHRONOC/JAVA_HOME):
python3 clients/compile_client.py --local --capacity storage_bw=100 -o /tmp/io.chb

# 3. Offline self-check – no network, no chronoc
#   (pinned lfc + a JRE are still required):
python3 clients/compile_client.py --check
```

scripts/compile_lf.sh compiles **lf/IoCoordinator.lf** to a **.chb** blob. It resolves the pinned **lfc** v0.13.0 and **chronoc** v0.1.0 from this repo's **toolchain/** directory — **lfc** is fetched automatically on first use (SHA-256 verified), **chronoc** is vendored (**toolchain/README.md** has its provenance and rebuild instructions). A JVM (Java 17+) is the only prerequisite: set **JAVA_HOME** or keep **java** on **PATH**.

```
scripts/compile_lf.sh lf/IoCoordinator.lf -o /tmp/io.chb \
    --capacity storage_bw=100
```

Env overrides: **CHRONOC=<path>**, **LFC=<path>**, **JAVA_HOME=<path>**.

The LF project in this package

lf/ is a complete, self-contained project — see **lf/README.md**. **lf/IoCoordinator.lf** is the canonical workload: a timed training loop (**Trainer**) driving periodic checkpoints (**CheckpointIO**) and read-ahead (**PrefetchIO**).

- Source SHA-256: `b71fb3fbaaac0eac7d2181f6651462d1324056b77780283a593569ac9373bf87`
- Verify: `sha256sum lf/IoCoordinator.lf`
- Reference blob: `lf/IoCoordinator.chb.reference` — the exact pinned-toolchain output for the checked-in source (`steps=200, storage_bw=100`), verified by `clients/compile_client.py --check`.

Toolchain pins

Component	Pin	Source
lfc	v0.13.0 (validation gate)	scripts/fetch-lfc.sh (SHA-256 verified)
chronoc	v0.1.0 (Rust, LF → .chb)	toolchain/chronoc-linux-x86_64 (vendored)
Blob format	.chb v1 (CHB1 magic, CRC-32 trailer)	
LF IDE extension	lf-lang.vscode-lingua-franca	VS Code Marketplace

Bumping the **lfc** pin requires re-validating every **.lf** source and recompiling every blob — blobs carry **lfc** provenance so staleness is detectable.